Weekly cisplatin + head and neck radiotherapy

Weekly cisplatin supports radiotherapy for locally advanced head and neck cancer when the three-weekly cisplatin schedule cannot be tolerated. The team explains why this approach fits your situation.

Locally advanced unresectable squamous head and neck cancer when three-weekly cisplatin cannot be tolerated. · NCCP 00385 v5 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Locally advanced unresectable squamous head and neck cancer when three-weekly cisplatin cannot be tolerated.

My overall treatment

Weekly cisplatin × 6 with radiation.



Cisplatin with radiotherapy

Cisplatin 40 mg/m² once a week for six planned doses during radiotherapy. Cisplatin is given before radiation on the same day. If radiotherapy is cancelled, cisplatin is held until radiation resumes; the team updates both calendars.

Recovery and follow-up

Mouth, skin, swallowing, energy and hydration may need support after radiation ends. The team arranges response assessment and follows hearing, kidney or nerve problems. Any further chemotherapy is a separate prescription.

A typical 7-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–7
Cisplatin then radiation	Radiation and support continue

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline safety and preparation** NCCP / radiation plan	Blood count, kidneys/liver; hearing/creatinine clearance (CrCl) if indicated. Dental, nutrition and radiation preparation.
During	**Bloods and symptoms** NCCP	Blood count, kidneys/liver before each cycle. Review hearing, nerves, intake and radiation symptoms.
After / response	**Follow-up and tests** NCCP / individual plan	Continue recovery, dental and swallowing care; scans and tests individually planned.

Between treatments

- Radiation has its own appointment calendar; mouth, skin and swallowing effects may build across weeks.
- Keep drinking and nutrition support active; seek help before intake or weight falls substantially.

Bring your medicine list, test dates, treatment calendar and actual urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Hearing / tinnitus

Cisplatin

Report ringing in the ears or hearing change before the next dose; effects can be lasting.

3 Blood cells / infection

Cisplatin

Fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding needs prompt oncology advice.

5 Nausea / appetite

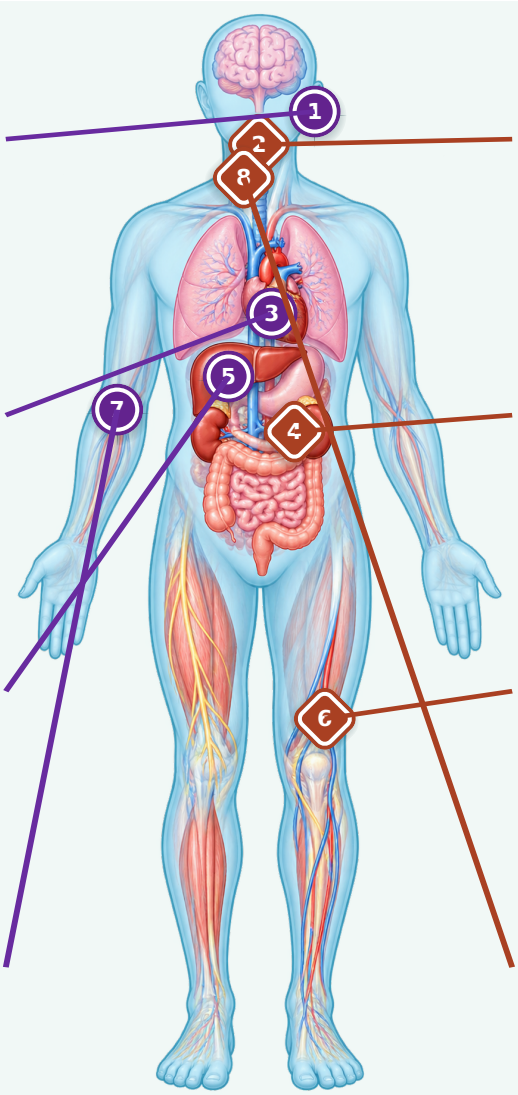
Cisplatin

Take the prescribed prevention and rescue medicines. Call if vomiting persists or fluids will not stay down.

7 Skin / treated area

Radiotherapy

Follow the radiation team’s skin plan. Report painful redness, peeling or a wound that is not healing.



2 Mouth / throat / saliva

Head and neck radiotherapy

Mouth pain, thick saliva, dry mouth or swallowing difficulty can limit drinking; seek help early.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Cisplatin

Much less urine, persistent vomiting or inability to drink needs urgent advice. Drip fluids and blood tests help protect kidneys.

6 Nerves / hands / feet

Cisplatin

Report numbness, tingling, balance problems or difficulty with fine tasks; symptoms can persist.

8 Teeth / jaw / swallowing

Head and neck radiotherapy

Dental review, nutrition and swallowing support continue through recovery. Report jaw stiffness, weight loss or choking.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Contact oncology promptly for fever, sudden illness, persistent vomiting, much less urine, severe mouth pain or inability to drink. Report hearing change, ringing in the ears or new numbness before the next dose. Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse is an emergency.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital’s temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Weekly cisplatin + radiotherapy (RT)

Weekly cisplatin × 6 with radiation.

Phase: _____ Planned weekly doses: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My treatment record

Team stamps after each completed treatment.

W1	W2	W3	
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials	My treatment information
W4	W5	W6	
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials	

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.